

Psychological Problems	Content
Key Concepts	- An introduction to mental health: - ways of defining mental health, including the mental health continuum - the current prevalence of mental health problems, including current statistics and differences between age; gender; and sexual orientation - the incidence of significant mental health problems over time, including changing classification; similarities and differences; and how attitudes have changed towards mental health in the UK since the 1959 Mental Health Act. - The effects of significant mental health problems on the individual and society: - the effects of stigma on individuals before and after diagnosis - the effects of discrimination on individuals before and after diagnosis - the effects of significant mental health problems on the wider society, including care in the community.
Theories/Explanations	<u>Schizophrenia</u> - The clinical characteristics of schizophrenia as outlined in the International Classification of Diseases (ICD)¹ - Key statistics of schizophrenia including reference to prevalence; age; sex; ethnicity; and recovery rates
Biological Explanation of Schizophrenia	- The biological theory of schizophrenia: <u>the dopamine hypothesis – the role of dopaminergic neurons and synaptic transmission in an overactive dopamine system causing high dopamine levels in the brain</u> <u>how the structure and functions of the brain relates to cognitions and behaviour; brain dysfunction in relation to brain volume and brain activity – the roles of the frontal lobes; hippocampus; and temporal lobes; and the impact of neurological damage in schizophrenia</u> - criticisms of this theory including the nature/nurture debate.
Psychological Explanation of Schizophrenia	- The psychological theory - the social drift theory of schizophrenia: - rejection by society - disengagement of individuals - criticisms of this theory including problems establishing cause and effect. Schizophrenia Research Study– the role of monoamines on cerebral function during specific prefrontal